



SABLE HARBOR — ADVISORY / ATLAS MERIDIAN CLOSEOUT

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State: LOCKED DIRECTION except where a row is explicitly marked OPEN or MODEL_PROPOSED

Authority: Owner-approved design session; accepted repository integration makes the decision controlling

Supersedes in part: ADV-002 open-form treatment and any Atlas organization language that treats Atlas personnel as an advisory or engagement-delivery bench

Preserves: ADV-001; ATL-001–ATL-015; J2 professional doctrine; Foundry/Foundry Field distinctions; Sable Harbor governance and authority doctrine

1. Controlling proposition

Sable Harbor Advisory is a professional-services business built as if the post-pyramid, AI-native consulting model already exists. It does not sell labor capacity, slideware, or generic best practices. It accepts consequential problems, forms a problem-specific human and machine team, intervenes against a defined outcome, proves what changed, transfers durable capability to the client, and exits without manufacturing dependency.

Atlas Meridian is the professional system through which that work is conducted. Atlas Meridian remains a commercial product, but its Sable Harbor organization is a **product organization**. Atlas Meridian personnel build, secure, operate, and improve the system; they are not an internal consulting pool and are not staffed into Advisory matters as substitute consultants merely because they build the platform.

Foundry Field remains Sable Harbor's flagship deployable operational product. This closeout does not reduce or supersede Foundry Field.

2. Advisory business architecture

ADV-101 — Organizational relationship to J2 — LOCKED

Advisory is adjacent to J2, not inside J2. J2 exists to serve Sable Harbor's internal intelligence, judgment, orientation, learning, and institutional-memory purposes. Advisory exists to serve clients. Commercial pressure must not obtain authority over J2 priorities, staffing, conclusions, professional standards, or access.

J2 may inform enterprise doctrine and may learn from properly governed enterprise experience. Advisory may employ former J2 professionals under the talent rules below. Neither relationship makes J2 a feeder organization for Advisory.

ADV-102 — Three practices, one bench — LOCKED

Advisory has three market-facing practices but one common professional bench:

1. **Intelligence Advisory** — determine what is actually happening, what is knowable, what is not, and what a consequential decision should take into account.
2. **Intelligence Capability** — establish a client's durable intelligence capability: questions, collection, accountable problem ownership, challenge, orientation, institutional memory, education, workflows, and supporting systems adapted to the client's context.
3. **Operational Excellence** — improve hard physical and organizational operations using Sable Harbor's operating

experience without transferring protected Sable Harbor trade secrets, proprietary technical methods, or operating assets.

Practice labels describe client demand and professional depth. They do not create three staffing silos. Matters are staffed from the common bench around the problem.

ADV-103 — Professional-production model — LOCKED

The unit of production is the **matter**, not the utilization hour and not the practice silo. A matter may draw operators, former J2 professionals, technologists, economists, engineers, data specialists, domain experts, and Atlas Meridian agent constellations in whatever combination the problem requires.

The standard engagement arc is:

Frame → Observe → Understand → Intervene → Prove → Transfer → Exit / Remain Reachable.

A matter is not complete merely because a report was delivered. Where the engagement creates an ongoing workflow, model, analytical process, or agent capability, transfer is part of the work unless the contract explicitly establishes a managed-service relationship.

3. Governance and professional responsibility

ADV-104 — President of Advisory — LOCKED ROLE / NAME OPEN

Advisory is an operating business led by a President of Sable Harbor Advisory. The President owns the business line, subject to Sable Harbor's existing corporate governance, delegated authority, reserved matters, legal structure, and Board/CEO authority. The individual is OPEN.

ADV-105 — Matter Principal — LOCKED

Every matter has one Matter Principal with non-delegable accountability for the client commitment, professional quality, outcome definition, staffing logic, escalation, and transfer standard. Relationship origination does not automatically confer Matter Principal authority.

ADV-106 — Matter acceptance — LOCKED

Every matter requires an Acceptance Principal other than the originating commercial sponsor to affirm, at minimum:

- client and beneficial counterparty understood;
- problem and requested authority understood;
- competence exists or can be assembled honestly;
- conflicts and independence implications are identified;
- information, security, legal, regulatory and data-rights conditions are workable;
- economics and outcome-measurement terms are coherent;
- Sable Harbor is not being retained to manufacture a preferred conclusion;
- the matter does not imply operating, assurance, fiduciary, legal, audit, or other authority Sable Harbor has not accepted.

Legal, Finance, Security, Risk/Controls, and other enterprise functions retain veto or stop rights within their established domains. They do not become a permanent taste-based consulting committee. Matters crossing reserved-matter thresholds escalate through existing corporate authority.

ADV-107 — Independent value verification — LOCKED

Advisory maintains a small **Value Office** independent of matter delivery. It approves outcome baselines, measurement definitions, attribution logic, measurement windows, client dependencies, and final outcome certification for variable-fee matters. The Value Office may not improve a matter team's economics by rewriting a baseline after

work begins.

ADV-108 — Independent professional review — LOCKED

Consequential matters receive an independent reviewer who did not originate the matter and does not share delivery ownership. The reviewer may challenge evidence, reasoning, safety, professional claims, outcome attribution, and transfer readiness. Review is not a second command chain.

ADV-109 — Conclusions are not for sale — LOCKED

A client purchases Sable Harbor's work, judgment, intervention, and agreed outcome economics. A client does not purchase a predetermined conclusion. Commercial disappointment is not a basis to alter evidence or professional judgment.

4. Talent system and J2 boundary

ADV-110 — Open Advisory hiring — LOCKED

Advisory may recruit externally and may recruit aggressively, including by name, from Sable Harbor operating business lines, subject to ordinary internal mobility and continuity controls. Operating-line professionals are especially valuable because the Advisory model treats tacit operating experience as a scarce professional asset rather than as background color.

Advisory remains open to people who have never served in J2. J2 service is not a prerequisite to an Advisory career.

ADV-111 — Absolute serving-J2 non-solicitation — LOCKED

Advisory must not recruit, solicit, court, pre-negotiate with, reserve a future role for, promise economics to, open an application for, or create an expectation of Advisory employment with any person while that person is serving in J2.

A serving J2 professional may not begin the Advisory application process. Advisory personnel must not invite one to do so. The initiative must come from the individual **after qualifying J2 service has ended**.

There is no post-service cooling-off period once the relevant J2 service is actually complete. The prohibition is on contamination of service, not on artificial delay after service.

Orientation Officers receive the strictest interpretation: no post-commission placement discussion, role-shaping, economics discussion, carry discussion, application, interview, or informal courtship while in commission.

ADV-112 — Carry restricted to former qualifying J2 professionals — LOCKED

Sable Harbor Advisory may use **carry** as the formal term for long-duration Advisory economic participation. Carry is reserved to former J2 professionals who satisfy a qualifying-service gate. Advisory may pay outsiders and operating-line hires extremely well, including through salary, bonus, profit participation or other approved compensation, but they do not receive Advisory carry solely through Advisory service.

Carry eligibility is a recognition of completed institutional service, not compensation for leaving J2 and not an entitlement created while serving.

Eligibility does not equal allocation. Carry is earned and allocated inside Advisory under a separately governed economic plan.

ADV-113 — Orientation carry gate — LOCKED

A former commissioned Orientation Officer becomes carry-eligible only after completing:

- one full Orientation tour/commission under controlling J2 doctrine; **and**
- one qualifying fellowship.

Completion establishes eligibility automatically. It does not create an automatic carry percentage.

The permanent Orientation anti-line-authority bargain remains intact. A former Orientation Officer may pursue an

exceptionally lucrative non-line professional career in Advisory, including carry, but may not use Advisory to reacquire C-suite line office, operating-VP authority, or equivalent line decision-making power prohibited by Orientation doctrine.

ADV-114 — Judgment carry gate — LOCKED

A former Judgment Officer becomes carry-eligible after completing both:

- at least five years in a Judgment Officer position; and
- at least two years of substantive service in an actual Sable Harbor operating business line.

JAG service does not substitute for the two-year operating-line requirement. JAG is a temporary field-tour mechanism, not a permanent business line or Judgment billet.

ADV-115 — Contact carry gate — LOCKED

A former Contact professional becomes carry-eligible after at least four years in substantive **Contact leadership**, with genuine responsibility for people and collection outcomes. Title inflation alone does not satisfy the requirement.

The Contact threshold is intentionally high because Contact is a standing intelligence profession with less natural operating-line laterality than Judgment and because Advisory must not become the financial reason people seek Contact leadership.

ADV-116 — Education / other J2 carry gate — OPEN

No carry gate for Education, J2 Headquarters, or other unaddressed J2 service is created by this closeout. Those rules remain OPEN until explicitly decided.

ADV-117 — Carry economics — LOCKED DIRECTION / MECHANICS OPEN

Advisory is intended to be Sable Harbor's **highest-upside** professional career destination, not automatically its highest-paid branch in every year or role. Carry must reward durable Advisory value creation over time rather than title, utilization, or short-term billing.

Exact pool size, allocation formula, vesting, forfeiture, realization event, valuation, clawback, tax structure, and treatment on retirement/departure remain OPEN pending finance/legal design.

5. Atlas Meridian product architecture

ATL-101 — Atlas team becomes a product organization — LOCKED

Atlas Meridian's dedicated team consists of product developers and the supporting product disciplines required to build and operate Atlas Meridian. The team owns product engineering, product management, product design, reliability, security, evaluation, data/platform architecture, agent/runtime infrastructure, client-tenancy controls, transfer tooling, and product support.

Atlas personnel may work with Advisory to understand requirements, support product incidents, conduct controlled design partnership, and improve the platform. They are not an Advisory staffing reserve, and their work on a matter does not make them the matter's professional owner.

ATL-102 — Atlas Meridian is both product and professional substrate — LOCKED

Atlas Meridian has two simultaneous roles:

1. a commercial client product capable of standing on its own; and
2. the professional workbench and relationship system through which Sable Harbor Advisory conducts AI-native matters.

The commercial product must not be intentionally crippled to manufacture services demand. Advisory becomes valuable when the client's problem exceeds ordinary self-service capability, requires professional judgment, crosses domains, or demands an intervention the client should not perform alone.

ATL-103 — Two-plane architecture — LOCKED DIRECTION

Atlas Meridian is designed around a **Sable Harbor professional plane** and a **client plane**.

The often-used 70/30 language is a design heuristic, **not an ownership split, revenue share, data-rights ratio, or literal code percentage**.

The professional plane may contain Sable Harbor proprietary orchestration, professional methods, cross-matter learning, internal evaluation infrastructure, protected prompts/policies, internal agent capabilities, firm-only knowledge and controls, and other material that a client does not acquire merely by retaining Advisory.

The client plane contains the client's data, evidence, matter records, authorized models, workflows, client-specific agents, decisions, action records, client-safe provenance, transfer artifacts, and licensed Atlas Meridian product capability.

ATL-104 — Client portal and matter front door — LOCKED

For Advisory clients, Atlas Meridian is the primary digital front door to the professional relationship. Subject to contract and security classification it provides:

- secure file and evidence transfer;
- structured requests and request status;
- data-room and provenance functions;
- client/system connectors;
- matter workspaces;
- issue, assumption and decision records;
- findings and evidence traceability;
- outcome baseline and measurement records;
- collaboration and review;
- agent/workflow execution appropriate to the client plane;
- transfer and acceptance records;
- the durable client-side record of what was done, what changed, and why.

Email, meetings, field work and other channels remain valid; Atlas is the coherent matter system, not a requirement to force every human interaction through a portal.

ATL-105 — Engagement constellations — LOCKED

Each AI-enabled matter may instantiate a problem-specific **agent constellation**. Agents are composed around the matter rather than sold as generic digital headcount. Human professionals remain accountable for professional judgment, client commitments, unsafe actions, escalation, and conclusions.

Atlas must preserve which agent/model/tool acted, what evidence it could access, what authority it had, what it produced, what human reviewed or adopted, and what changed over time.

ATL-106 — Client-ownable derivative / constellation transfer — LOCKED

Where a matter creates a durable automated workflow or agent capability, Advisory must be able to produce a hardened, validated, client-ownable derivative inside the client's Atlas Meridian environment, subject to the contract and the protected-IP boundary.

The transferred derivative may include client-specific agents, workflows, prompts/instructions, connectors, client data, client-specific memory, tests, runbooks, controls, measurement logic and operating documentation necessary for the client to run what it owns.

It does **not** automatically include Sable Harbor's proprietary professional plane, cross-client memory, internal evaluation corpus, protected methods, unrelated agents, trade secrets, source code not licensed to the client, or firm-

only institutional knowledge.

The transfer objective is: **the client leaves with the people capability and the machine capability required to continue the work without pretending it now owns Sable Harbor.**

ATL-107 — Three commercial modes — LOCKED DIRECTION

Atlas/Advisory supports three client modes that can coexist within one relationship:

- **Tell me** — Sable Harbor conducts the matter using the professional plane and delivers the decision-grade result and agreed client record.
- **Work with me** — Sable Harbor and client work jointly in a client-visible matter workspace, with professional-plane capability applied behind the controlled boundary.
- **Let me do it myself** — the client licenses and operates the client-plane product without a standing Advisory engagement, escalating to Advisory when professional intervention is warranted.

6. Matter economics

ADV-118 — No hourly commercial model — LOCKED DIRECTION

Advisory does not price its core professional work by billable hour, seat count, junior leverage, or token consumption. Internal cost accounting may measure time and compute; those measures do not become the value proposition.

ADV-119 — Matter-value contract — LOCKED DIRECTION

For outcomes that can be economically measured, a matter establishes before substantive work:

- the matter-value basis;
- baseline and source data;
- target state;
- attribution rules;
- client obligations and dependencies;
- exclusions and force-majeure treatment;
- measurement period;
- certification method;
- committed fee;
- outcome-variable fee and cap;
- dispute and restatement mechanics.

Atlas Meridian retains the governed value schedule and measurement record. The Value Office certifies the baseline and final measurement independently of the delivery team.

ADV-120 — 60/40 target economics — MODEL_PROPOSED

The working commercial default for a measurable transformation matter is **60% committed / 40% outcome-variable** against a negotiated target fee. Variable economics may scale down to zero when the agreed outcome is not achieved and may scale above target for exceptional verified outcomes only within a contractual cap.

This is the default design target, not an inflexible rule for every client or matter.

ADV-121 — Matter-value rate bands — MODEL_PROPOSED

The following working rate bands provide a real-world quoting discipline while allowing matter-specific adjustment:

Verified addressable matter value	Target fee as % of value	Typical posture
Under \$5M	10–15%	high-intensity bounded matter; minimum economics apply
\$5M–\$25M	7–12%	transformation / operational intervention
\$25M–\$100M	4–8%	enterprise-scale consequential matter
\$100M–\$500M	2–4%	major program / capital / network outcome
Above \$500M	0.5–2.0%	negotiated; attribution and caps dominate

A minimum matter price protects the model from becoming a small-project body shop. The initial working minimum is **\$150,000** for an Advisory matter, excluding separately priced Atlas licensing and pass-through external costs. The President may approve a lower amount for strategic, research, public-interest, training, or design-partner reasons if the exception is explicit.

ADV-122 — Nonfinancial outcomes — LOCKED DIRECTION

Where the value cannot be responsibly reduced to dollars, pricing uses a fixed matter price plus objective acceptance milestones and, where appropriate, a variable tranche tied to independently testable capability outcomes. Examples include standing up an intelligence function, achieving validated process capability, reducing decision latency, transferring a governed agent workflow, or completing a defined operating-control state.

ADV-123 — Atlas continuity — LOCKED DIRECTION

Atlas Meridian licensing is commercially separate from Advisory matter economics. Clients may retain Atlas after an engagement and may use it without a standing Advisory team. Licensing should be institutional/value-based rather than a disguised billable-hour or token-metering scheme. Exact license tiers and prices remain OPEN for Atlas product pricing work.

7. Intellectual-property and dependency boundary

ADV-124 — Transfer capability, not Sable Harbor's crown jewels — LOCKED

Advisory teaches, configures, implements and transfers what the client requires to own its capability. It does not transfer Sable Harbor's unrelated trade secrets, protected cross-client learning, internal J2 records, proprietary professional-plane methods, nonlicensed Atlas source code, or operating-business technical secrets merely because those experiences informed the work.

Operational Excellence may teach a client how to establish a competent reclamation, logistics, mine-operating, maintenance, recovery, data, or other function without disclosing Sable Harbor-specific proprietary recipes, protected process parameters, counterparty information, mine data, or other trade secrets.

ADV-125 — No dependency theater — LOCKED

Advisory may sell continuing support, managed services, Atlas licensing, periodic review, or new matters. It must not intentionally make a client incapable of operating a capability that the engagement promised to transfer. A successful transfer may create future demand because the client can now attempt harder problems—not because Sable Harbor withheld the keys.

8. Explicit non-decisions

This closeout does not decide:

- the final protectable commercial name replacing the provisional Advisory label;
- the individual President of Advisory;

- Advisory legal-entity form;
- exact initial headcount or P&L;
- exact carry pool mechanics;
- Education/J2HQ carry qualification;
- Atlas Meridian license tiers and list prices;
- the complete Atlas implementation architecture or technology stack;
- any external assurance/audit status;
- any client-specific terms not stated in a signed contract.

9. Required implementation consequence

Current organization, control, finance, product, and publication files must be reconciled so that:

- Advisory is no longer described as merely an emerging unspecified method-transfer line where this closeout now supplies the answer;
- Atlas Meridian's current team is represented as a product organization rather than an engagement bench;
- J2 is not represented as an Advisory recruiting pool;
- carry eligibility and the Orientation anti-line bargain do not collide;
- the three Advisory practices share one bench;
- matter acceptance, independent value verification and professional review are represented;
- Atlas client/professional planes and client-ownable transfer are explicit;
- hourly/T&M implementation examples remain synthetic historical/finance fixtures rather than the controlling Advisory commercial doctrine.

Nothing is considered implemented merely because it was discussed in chat. The repository state controls.